

4.8 Gaming



Ah... the games people play

Ask any teenager or college-goer about the biggest advantage of having a computer at home, and in all probability, he'll say it's gaming. The gaming industry today stands at over \$20 billion (Rs 87,000 crore) in annual revenue. That, say many pundits, is bigger than Hollywood. So just mate the Internet, which is a behemoth of unaccountable proportions, with the gaming industry, and what you get is an unimaginable giant.

Gaming on the Internet, as of today, is restricted largely to Flash-based games or simple arcade games of the '80s. Sites such as Addictinggames.com and Liquidgeneration.com give a wide variety of games to choose from. Most of these games, at best, are stress relievers or two-minute shootouts.

The idea of making a game to promote a movie or a product has caught on in India only recently, with sites such as Hungama.com and C2W.com creating these customised games. Most of these can be played online. Sites such as Indiagames.com